

Reflective Essay: Skills Improved and Areas for Future Growth

Introduction

Throughout this course, I developed several technical and professional skills that will benefit me in future engineering and technology careers. In addition to learning new telecommunications concepts, I became more confident in researching technical topics, analyzing complex systems, and communicating technical information clearly. While I made significant progress, I also identified areas where I can continue improving as I prepare for more advanced coursework and industry experience.

Skills I Improved

One of the biggest skills I improved was my technical understanding of modern communication networks. I learned how technologies such as 5G, Open RAN, artificial intelligence, federated learning, and emerging 6G systems work together to improve wireless communication. As the course progressed, I became more comfortable understanding technical terminology and explaining complex networking concepts in my own words.

I also strengthened my problem-solving and critical thinking skills. Many assignments required analyzing network architectures, comparing different technologies, and evaluating the advantages and limitations of new communication systems. Instead of simply memorizing information, I learned to think about why certain technologies are used and how they solve real-world engineering problems.

Another important area of improvement was my technical communication. Writing reports, completing discussions, and explaining networking concepts helped me become more confident in presenting technical information in a clear and organized way. This is an important skill for engineers who need to communicate ideas with both technical and non-technical audiences.

Areas for Future Growth

Although I improved in many areas, there are still skills I want to continue developing. I would like to gain more hands-on experience with telecommunications tools, network simulation software, and real networking equipment. Practical experience will help reinforce the concepts I learned throughout this course and prepare me for future engineering projects.

I also want to continue improving my programming and data analysis skills. Since artificial intelligence and automation are becoming increasingly important in modern

telecommunications, strengthening my coding abilities will allow me to better understand and develop intelligent networking solutions. Learning more about cloud computing, cybersecurity, and network optimization will also support my long-term career goals.

Conclusion

Overall, this course helped me build a stronger foundation in both telecommunications and technical problem-solving. I improved my understanding of modern communication technologies, strengthened my analytical thinking, and became more confident in technical writing. Moving forward, I plan to continue building practical experience and expanding my technical skills so I am well prepared for future engineering courses and a career in the telecommunications industry.